

Coyote Unmanned Systems Corp.

RFI Response — FA8629-26-RFI-4ISR (Attritable ISR Aircraft)
Submitted: 21 May 2026 | POC: Janet Okafor, Capture Manager — jokafor@coyoteuas.example
Platform family: CU-11 Roadrunner (Block 1 and Block 2 configurations)

A. Approach and Configurations

Coyote offers the CU-11 Roadrunner in two configurations. **Block 1** is in production today. **Block 2** adds an extended-wing kit and heavy-fuel engine, entering production Q1 2027. Where performance differs by configuration, both values are given below. Values marked 'up to' reflect best-case mission profiles; nominal planning figures are also provided.

B. Aircraft (KPP 1)

Req ID	Requirement	Vendor Response
1.1	Range	Block 1: 175 km nominal (does not meet the 200 km threshold; see deviation request, Section E). Block 2: up to 620 km with extended-wing kit.
1.2	Loiter Time	Block 1: 5-6 hrs depending on payload weight. Block 2: 12-14 hrs nominal, up to 16 hrs with reduced payload.
1.3	Cruise Altitude	Typical 6,000-10,000 ft MSL; ceiling 16,500 ft (Block 1) / 19,000 ft (Block 2).
1.4	Climb Rate	Approximately 700 fpm (Block 1); 850 fpm (Block 2), standard day, max gross.
1.5	Max Speed	90 kt (Block 1); 105 kt (Block 2).
1.6	Operational Environment	Rain to 12 mm/hr; winds 25 kt; -20C to +45C. Icing not authorized.
1.7	Operational Attributes	Meets T=O. Vehicle-transportable; 3-person crew; 40 min setup; rail launch, parachute recovery to unimproved terrain.
1.8	Integration	Meets T=O. 300 W / 24 VDC payload power; integrates sensor, autopilot, comms, and nav subsystems.

C. Subsystems (KPPs 2-5) and GCS (KPP 10)

Communications: threshold (mission essential) is met via encrypted LOS link; Block 2 adds an optional L-band SATCOM providing secure BLOS FMV and metadata at 8-12 Mbps (below the 50 Mbps objective figure; full-rate FMV is downsampled). Link-16 is on the roadmap for late 2027 and is not offered in either current configuration. Navigation meets threshold; Block 2 optionally adds a chip-scale atomic clock and signals-of-opportunity receiver as an alternative PNT capability, partially achieving the objective (no INS upgrade; MEMS-grade inertial retained). Command and control meets T=O through both secure link operation and pre-programmed autonomous missions. Onboard processing: none in Block 1 (threshold); Block 2 offers an edge compute module performing vehicle-class ATR only - multi-INT fusion is not offered. All subsystem integration requirements at threshold are met; secure-network integration (objective) is achieved on the ground segment only, not airborne.

The GCS meets the threshold: two transit cases, 28 kg, mission-essential processing, and operation from a site separate from launch and recovery. It integrates with the aircraft, sensors, C3, navigation, and EUD (ATAK). Of the objective features, automated report generation is included (auto-generated SALUTE and imagery summary products pushed to EUD); the collaborative multi-analyst environment is not offered.

D. Sensors (KPPs 6-9)

Req ID	Requirement	Vendor Response
6.1	Image Type	EO/IR (threshold met). GSD 15 cm at 8,000 ft AGL. Multi-spectral/HD not offered.

Req ID	Requirement	Vendor Response
6.2	Storage	Meets T=O: 1 TB onboard retention until EUD handoff.
6.3	Integration	Meets T=O: post-mission and in-mission EUD download.
7.1	FMV FoV	Gimbaled 360-degree sensor (threshold met). WAMI not offered.
7.2	Video Type	EO/IR SD in Block 1; EO/IR HD in Block 2. GSD 18 cm at 3 km slant.
7.3	Processing Speed	50 Mbps met in Block 2. Block 1 processes at 30 Mbps and does not meet this requirement.
7.4	MTI Tracking	Block 2 only: single-target track, vehicles up to 50 km/h.
7.5	MTI Capacity	Block 2 only: up to 6 simultaneous tracks.
7.6	Laser Range Finder	Offered on Block 2 gimbal: 5 km, +/-5 m.
7.7	Laser Target Indicator	Not offered (eye-safety certification not pursued).
7.8	FMV Integration	Meets T=O.
8.1	Signal Waveform	Optional SIGINT nose (both blocks): 30 MHz-2.5 GHz detection/characterization; classified annex available.
8.2	Signal Integration	Meets T=O.
9.1	Other Sensors	Communications-relay payload and drop-capable ground sensor dispenser available.
9.2	Other Integration	Meets T=O for offered payloads.

E. Requested Deviation — Range Threshold (Req 1.1, Block 1)

Block 1 falls 25 km short of the 200 km range threshold. Consistent with Section 3 of the RFI, which invites trades that yield a more affordable and producible system, Coyote requests the Government consider Block 1's price point (\$ figures in pricing annex; roughly one-third of comparable Group 3 offerings) and immediate availability (900+ units/year today) against this shortfall. Where the full 200 km threshold is firm, Block 2 satisfies it with margin beginning Q1 2027, and we propose a bridge buy of Block 1 for training and CONUS exercises.

F. KSAs and Production

Airworthiness: Block 1 holds a completed USAF airworthiness assessment for its group type; Block 2 assessment planned to complete before first delivery. IFF: Mode 3 transponder standard on both blocks. Security: ground segment integrates with secure networks via GFE cross-domain solution; meets T=O. Manufacturing: 75 aircraft/month current, surge to 150/month within 60 days of contract start; initial Block 1 units deliverable 21 days ARO.